

on a child's marriage as a prestige play. *Ummm* , my dear uncles and aunts, thank you. It's been invaluable.

Thus on, I had a crash course of the mistakes made by my brethren. Upon digging a little more, the skeletons kept coming. What looked like a small problem on the surface, turned out to be a deep prejudice when it came to money. What was even more revealing was: I had made several errors in judgment when it came to money and acted with biases I didn't know I had. To bank a clean slate, I had to de-learn everything I knew about myself when it came to money. It all started with me believing that I'm a special unicorn and am different from the world. And this feeling resonated with the masses. We all thought we are abnormally good with money-psychology, but were actually far from it.

Mistakes we make with Money Management

Bride: *Where were you?*

Groom: *Playing roulette*

Bride: *How did you do?*

Groom: *Not bad. I lost 500 rupees.*

We have changed the way we eat, drink, socialize but irrational behaviour has seeped through our genes. ₹ 1000 in roulette winnings, 1000 in tax refund and 1000 in salary should have the same significance. In fact, the 1000 from all 3 sources will buy you the same quantity of chai. But it never is taken in the same vein.

In fact, if managing money had been about crunching numbers into a spreadsheet and following the plan to a T, we'd all be masters. *What trips us is the psychological hurdles that are set up to impede our journey.* But if you can pause and identify the different cognitive biases that you undergo, then you're all set to jump into financial stardom. Here are a few to get you started:

1. Rationalizations: Choice supportive bias